Susanne Hansen

Senior Executive Assistant

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SUMMARY

Senior executive assistant and fractional Chief of Staff who combines executive partnership, team leadership, and practical AI fluency. Brings seven years in senior executive assistant roles, fractional client work building CEO decision and project systems, and 3+ years as an Operations Manager with three direct reports. Has led an executive assistant team and built shared procedures that help people work consistently. Protects executive capacity through calendar judgment, meeting preparation, travel, and follow-through. Builds and manages AI agent teams and systems with defined roles, checked outputs, and human approval.

EXPERIENCE

Fractional Chief of Staff

June 2024 – Present

Chief of Staff services for multiple clients.

- Set up executive decision and project systems for a founder/CEO and managed executive projects to move strategic initiatives forward.
- Protected the founder/CEO's calendar and operational capacity, handled travel, and supported relationships across a fully remote team.
- Organized company offsites and a retreat.
- Sets up and manages teams of AI agents, including project-manager agents; has handed some AI systems over to clients.
- Uses defined agent roles, written runbooks, checked outputs, and human approval to keep AI-assisted work visible and under review.

Senior Executive Assistant · The Village Church, Flower Mound, Texas

January 2024 – December 2025

Hybrid. Strategic partner to the Executive Directors of Operations and of Engagement and Communications in a large multi-site organization. Worked across Communications and Marketing, and Technology and Operations.

- Owned two competing high-volume executive calendars as one integrated plan, prioritizing requests, resolving conflicts, and protecting prep time before high-visibility meetings.
- Planned executive retreats and supported the leadership team's meeting rhythm: handled logistics and prepared agendas, briefing materials, presentations, and talking points; turned notes into executive summaries and tracked decisions, action items, owners, and deadlines to completion.
- Managed an executive inbox with a global audience: filtered and flagged, drafted replies and correspondence for signature, and surfaced only what needed the executive.
- Coordinated vendor, architect, and construction meetings and supported Operations budget preparation for a multi-year, multi-campus buildout.
- Helped onboard new hires and kept priorities, commitments, and relationships steady through executive and administrative staff turnover.
- Proposed an AI readiness program, recruited the people who wanted in, and led the workshops; in Communications and Marketing, ran a one-on-one discovery session with each team member. Served on the three-person executive team for AI implementation and use policy.
- After a restructuring, stepped in as a de facto consultant and built role-specific workflows that helped Communications and Marketing through 45% departmental turnover in four months.

Executive Ghostwriter · Independent Contractor January 2022 – December 2024

Fully remote. Strategic partner to clients including health-tech founders and ed-tech leaders.

- Managed projects, timelines, and client expectations in close collaboration with each principal's product and technology teams.
- Shaped the narrative, then wrote the thought leadership, presentations, and book chapters published under each principal's name, in strict confidence.

Inflight Crew · American Airlines May 2018 – December 2022

A long-held goal, pursued between executive roles.

- Delivered calm, professional service on domestic and international routes on a schedule that changed constantly, including the days the operation broke down; learned from the inside where an itinerary fails and how to plan around it.
- Saw a communication gap between the crew on the line and the administration, and was selected to work with the administration on in-flight crew policy training and compliance.

Senior Executive Assistant · Bent Tree Church, Carrollton, Texas January 2013 – May 2018

A large Dallas-based church with campuses in two states. Gatekeeper and high-touch support for the Senior Pastor on a local and international speaking schedule; also supported the operational team and the board.

- Owned the calendar, speaking engagements, and all domestic and international travel, including remote regions, from booking through travel risk and security, and stayed on call while the Senior Pastor traveled.
- Led the executive assistant team and provided back-up support when a teammate was out; also led other initiatives and projects from research through training and implementation.
- Prepared expense reports and budget analysis with the Director of Finance; drafted correspondence and first-pass presentations.
- Sat on the strategic team for a multi-campus expansion and led the communications and SOP work to open a new campus: brought in staff from the other sites to train the new team on values and culture, routed all communication through the main office, and put every campus on one playbook.
- Served as the first point of contact for staff, guests, donors, and public-relations contacts, screening requests and declining what didn't belong on the calendar.
- Managed donor relations and events in support of a $22 million fundraiser; hosted visiting speakers and coordinated their green room with the event staff.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Operations Manager (3+ years, 3 direct reports) · Financial Analyst, Arthur Andersen / Accenture · Statistical Forecasting and Analysis, Mary Kay Cosmetics

TOOLS

Google Workspace (Gmail, Calendar, Drive, Docs, Sheets) · Zoom, Slack · Asana, Notion · Mac · AI: Claude, ChatGPT, Grok, Gemini, Microsoft Copilot · Microsoft Office (Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams), SharePoint, OneDrive

EDUCATION & ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Bachelor of Business Administration, Accounting · Southern Methodist University, Dallas, Texas

English and Danish

Valid passport and active driver's license; happy to travel domestically and internationally.